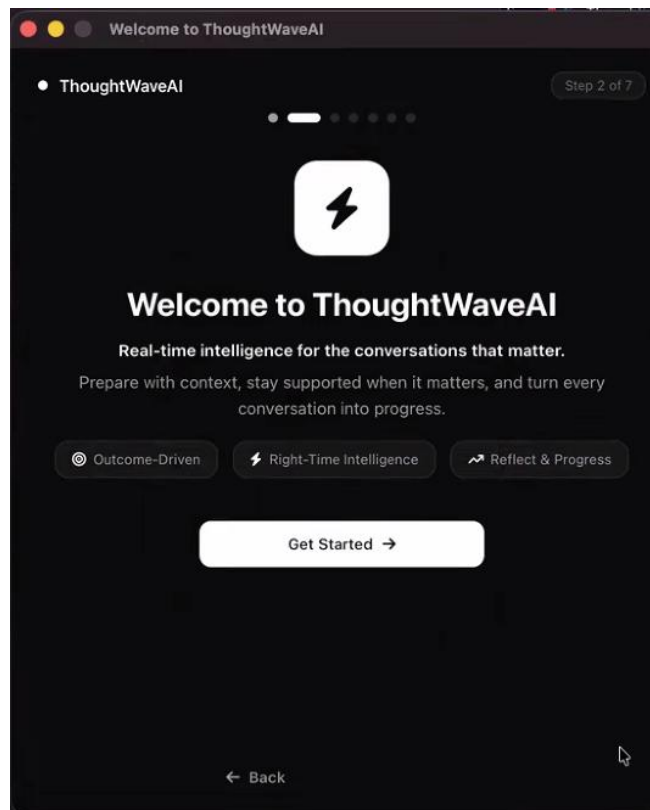


THOUGHTWAVEAI

Installation Guide

macOS Setup



Welcome to ThoughtWaveAI

A clear, step-by-step setup guide for first-time Mac users.

Before You Begin

ThoughtWaveAI guides you through account setup, AI-provider configuration, permissions, local speech setup, and the speech-model download. Most users should be able to complete setup entirely from the app.

- Move ThoughtWaveAI to the Applications folder before opening it.
- Keep an internet connection available during setup for provider verification and local speech components.
- Have the API key for the AI provider you plan to use. Current builds support Gemini, OpenAI, and Anthropic.
- macOS will ask for privacy permissions needed by the features you enable, including Microphone and Screen Recording.
- ThoughtWaveAI automatically looks for a compatible 64-bit Python runtime (Python 3.10–3.13) and creates its own local Whisper environment. You do not need to configure a Python path manually.

Updated installation flow

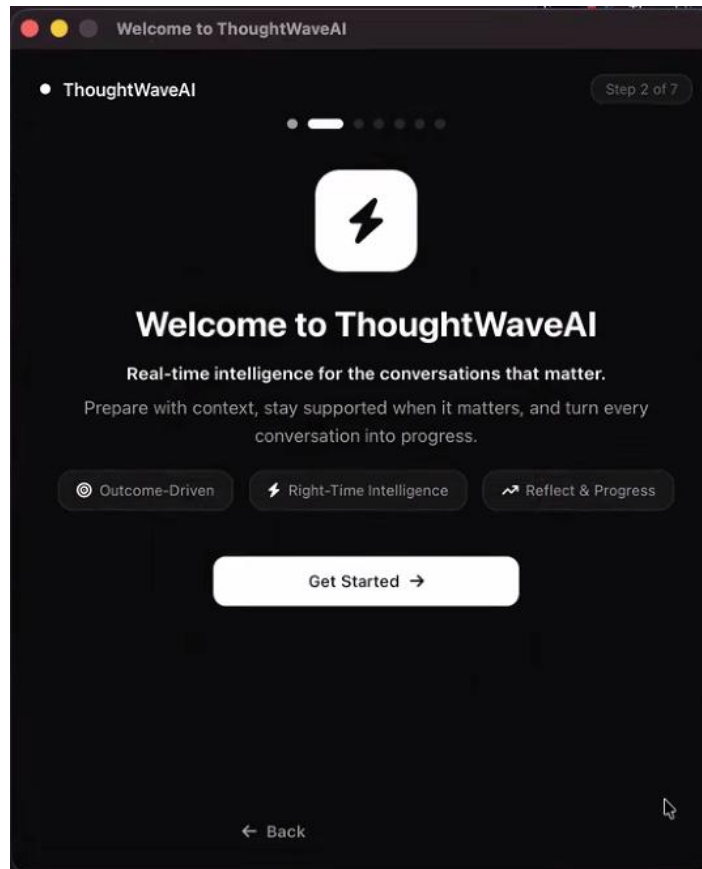
The old Terminal commands for clearing quarantine, manually locating Python, editing PATH, and manually installing Whisper are not part of the normal installation flow anymore. Use the in-app setup first; troubleshooting steps are provided only if setup reports a problem.

If macOS blocks the app

For a signed/notarized release, open ThoughtWaveAI normally from Applications. If macOS blocks the app, first try to open ThoughtWaveAI once. Then open Apple menu > System Settings > Privacy & Security, scroll to Security, and click Open Anyway next to the message about ThoughtWaveAI. Authenticate if macOS asks, then click Open to confirm. Open Anyway normally appears only after macOS has blocked an attempted launch. Do not disable Gatekeeper globally.

Step 1 — Install and Open ThoughtWaveAI

Drag ThoughtWaveAI into Applications, then open it. The onboarding window walks you through the remaining setup.



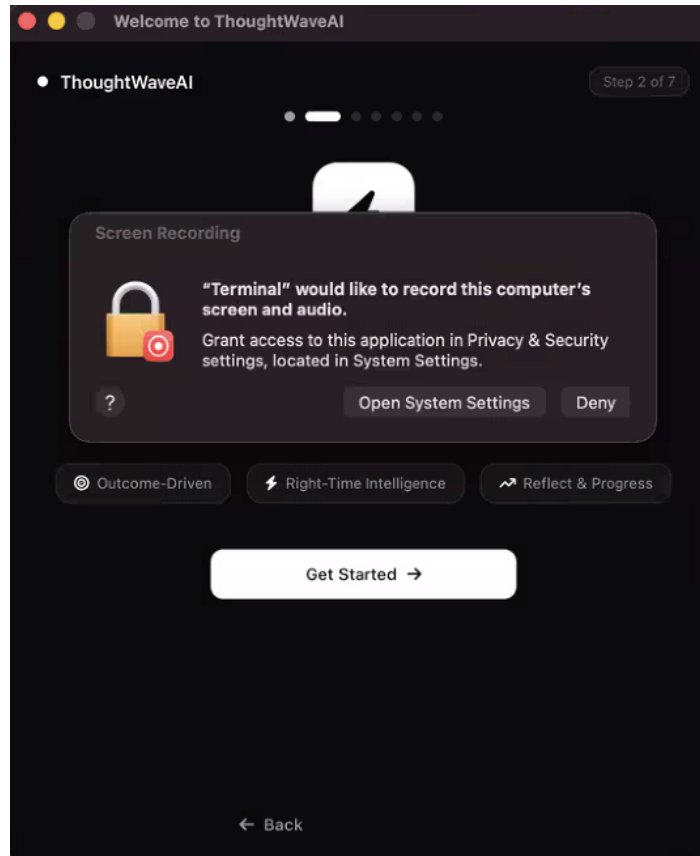
Click Get Started to begin onboarding.

Tip

Complete onboarding in order. If a step is not ready, ThoughtWaveAI keeps Continue disabled until the required setup is complete.

Step 2 — Grant macOS Permissions

ThoughtWaveAI needs macOS permission for the inputs you use during a session. When macOS prompts you, open System Settings and enable the requested access.



When prompted, choose Open System Settings and grant the requested permission.

- Microphone: allows ThoughtWaveAI to capture your microphone input.
- Screen Recording: allows Screen Context and supported system/screen capture features.

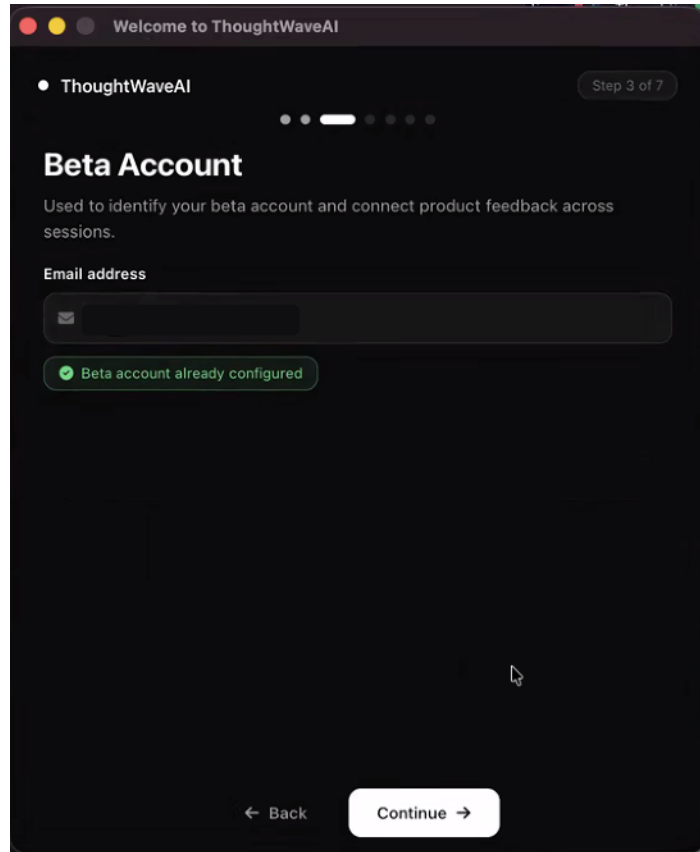
If macOS asks you to quit and reopen ThoughtWaveAI after changing a privacy permission, do so, then return to onboarding.

Why the screenshot may look slightly different

This illustrative screenshot comes from an earlier build and may show different process or app labels. In the current packaged release, follow the macOS prompt for ThoughtWaveAI and use the same Privacy & Security permission categories.

Step 3 — Confirm Your Account

Enter the email address associated with your ThoughtWaveAI access, then continue when the account is confirmed.

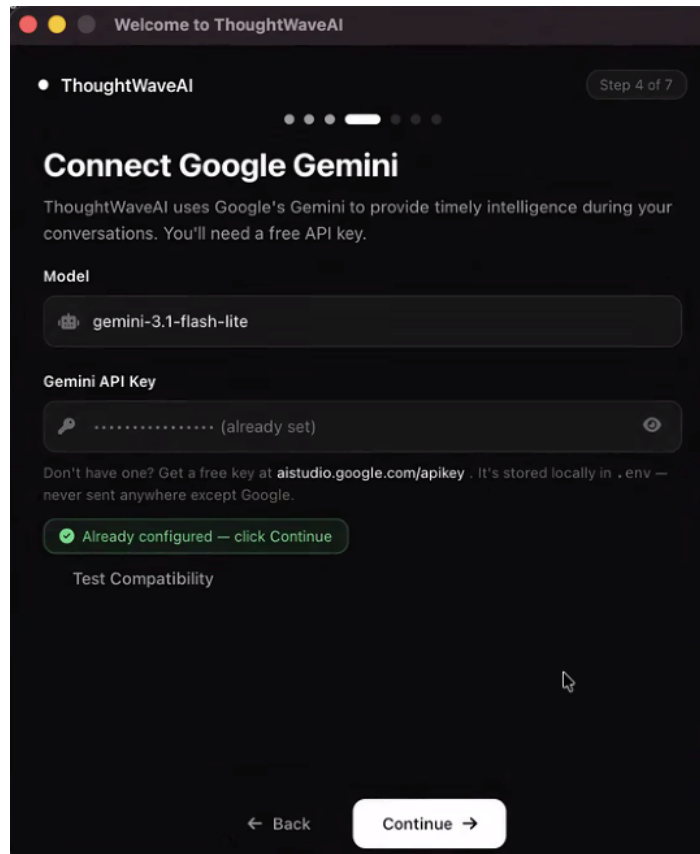


Enter your email address. A successful configuration is shown in green. This illustrative screenshot is from an earlier build, so account labels may differ in the current release.

Step 4 — Choose and Test Your AI Provider

Select the provider and model you want ThoughtWaveAI to use, enter that provider's API key, and run Test Compatibility before continuing.

- Supported initial providers: Gemini, OpenAI, and Anthropic.
- Choose a model that supports the capabilities you plan to use. Screen Context requires compatible visual input support.
- The compatibility check validates access to the configured model and required capabilities before you continue.



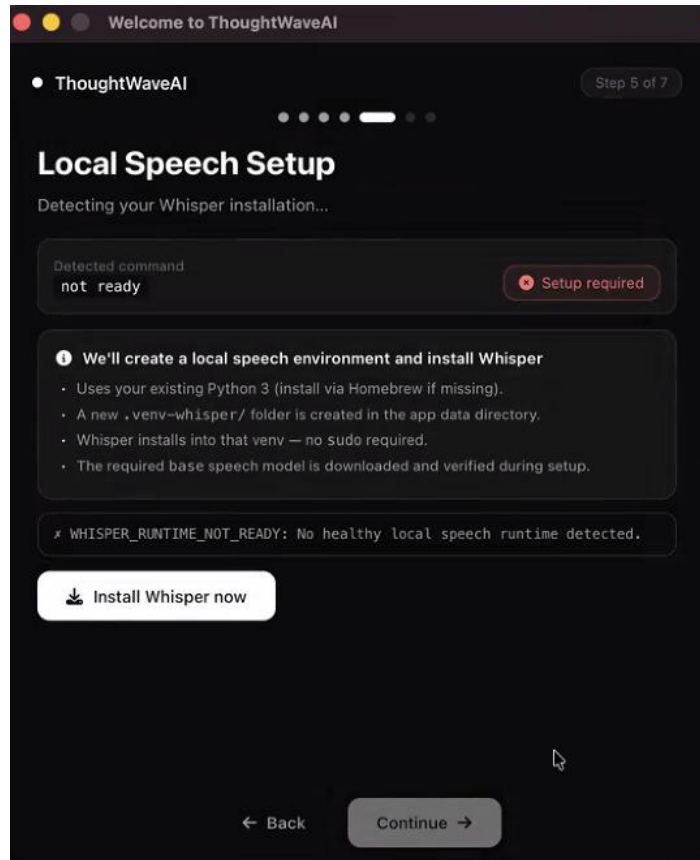
Illustrative screenshot from an earlier build showing Gemini configuration. Current builds support provider selection, so the exact fields and labels may differ for Gemini, OpenAI, or Anthropic.

Provider keys

Use an API key issued by the provider you selected. ThoughtWaveAI sends required conversation context to that selected cloud provider when cloud intelligence is used; do not assume all processing stays on-device.

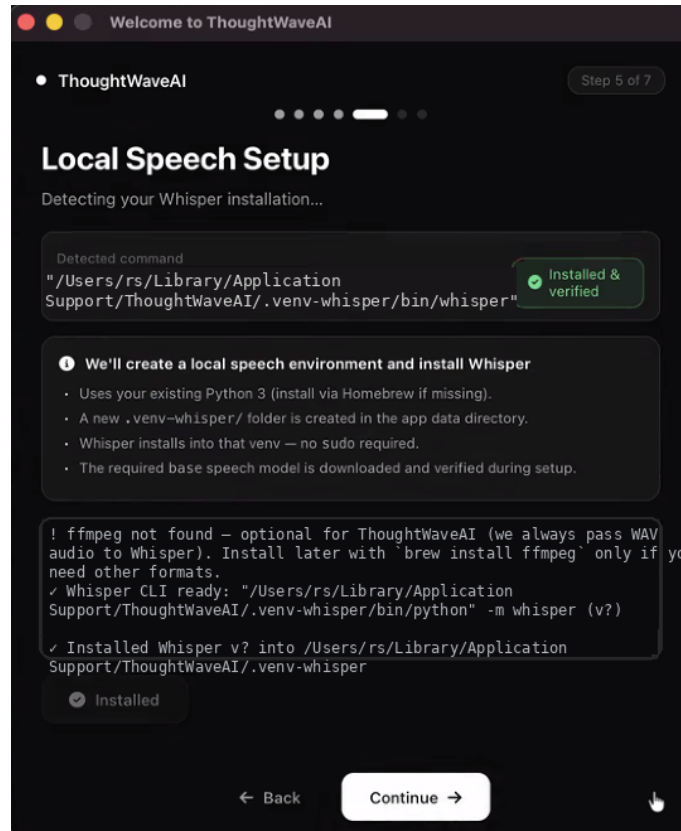
Step 5 — Set Up Local Speech

ThoughtWaveAI checks your Mac for a compatible Python runtime and prepares an isolated local Whisper environment.



*If setup is required, click **Install Whisper now**. ThoughtWaveAI handles the local environment and installation.*

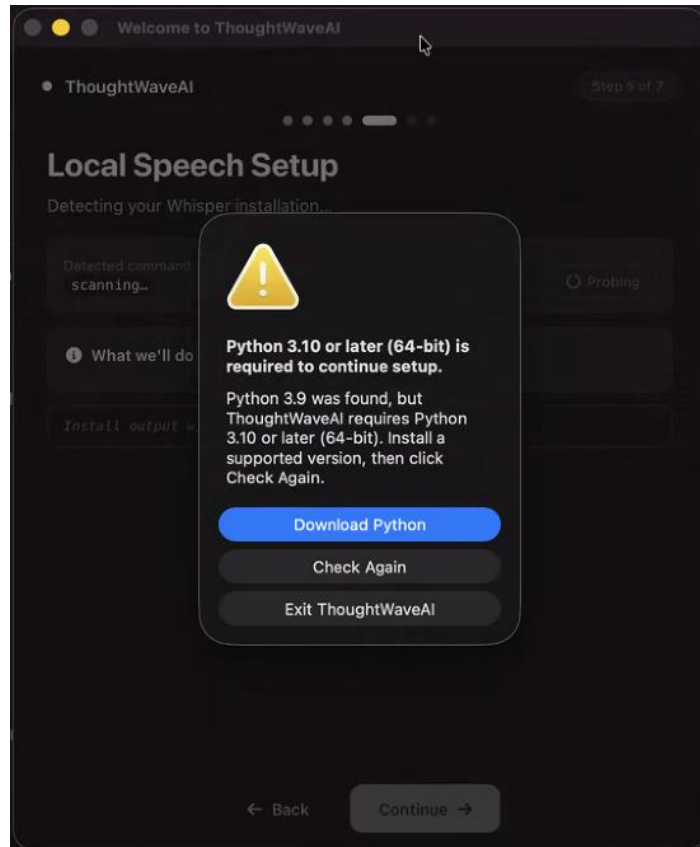
When installation completes successfully, the screen changes to **Installed & verified**.



Installed & verified means the local Whisper environment is ready.

Only if Local Speech Setup reports that Python is missing

You no longer need to search for Python paths or edit your shell PATH manually. ThoughtWaveAI's shared runtime resolver automatically checks compatible locations and uses the first supported 64-bit Python runtime it finds.



If no compatible runtime is available, use the options shown by ThoughtWaveAI.

Recommended recovery:

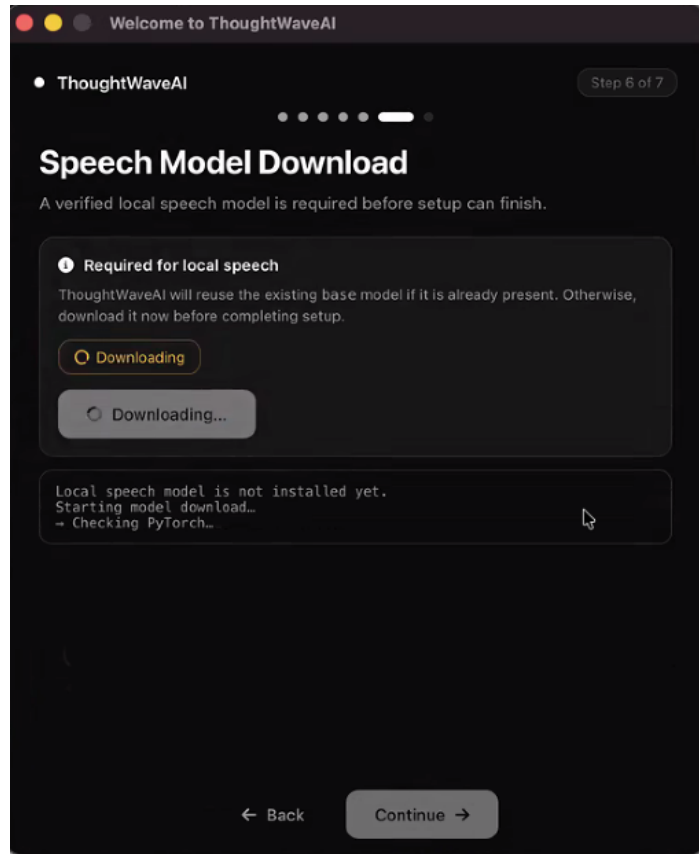
1. Choose Download Python (or follow the installer/link presented by the app).
2. **Install a supported 64-bit Python version (3.10–3.13).**
3. Return to ThoughtWaveAI and choose Check Again.
4. When Python is detected, continue with Install Whisper now.

Do not use the old workaround by default

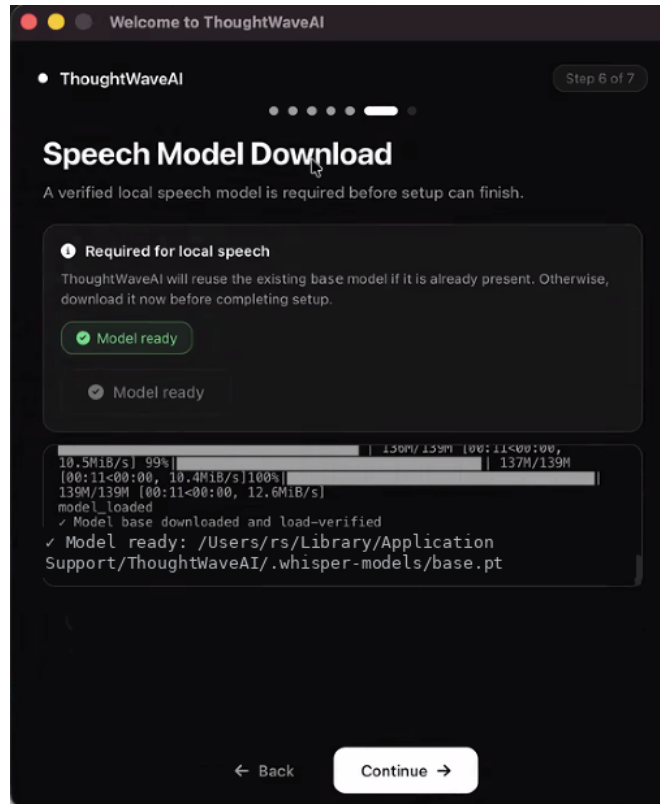
The earlier guide used Homebrew commands, PATH edits, and a direct pip install into `.venv-whisper`. Those steps are now troubleshooting-only and should not be required for a normal installation.

Step 6 — Download the Local Speech Model

ThoughtWaveAI requires a verified local speech model before onboarding can finish. The app downloads and verifies it for you.



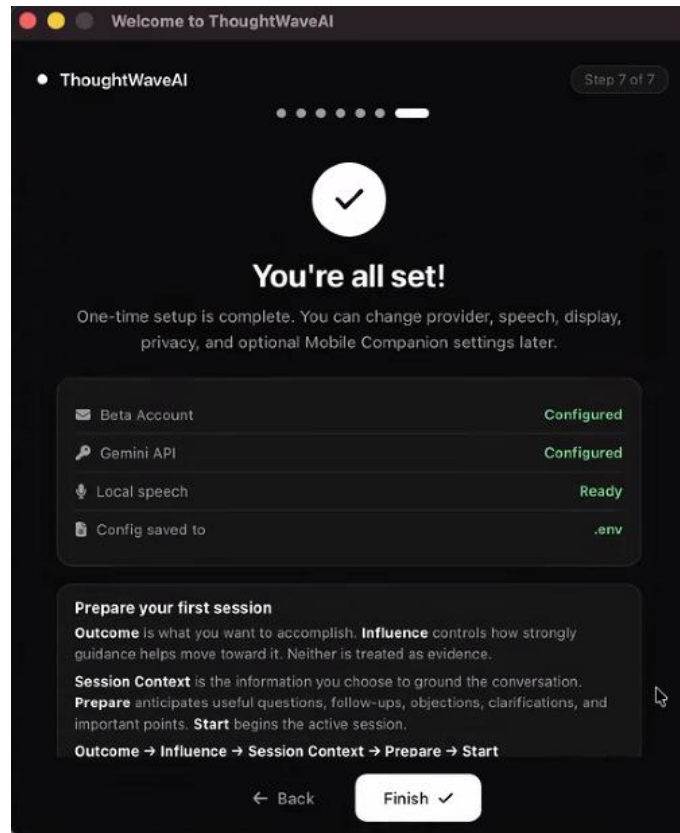
Keep ThoughtWaveAI open while the model downloads and verifies.



When Model ready appears, click Continue.

Step 7 — Finish Setup

The final screen summarizes the completed configuration. Confirm the required items are ready, then click Finish.



You're all set. Click Finish to open ThoughtWaveAI. The illustrative screenshot is from an earlier build, so account and provider labels may differ in the current release.

Your first session

In Prepare, set the Outcome and Influence and add Session Context when useful. Start the session when ready. During the conversation, ThoughtWaveAI can use Discussion, Ask TW, Assist, and TW Intelligence Assist. After the session, use Review, Download, and Summarize.

Privacy reminder

ThoughtWaveAI does not need a visible meeting bot to join your call. Local speech processing runs on your Mac; cloud intelligence uses the AI provider you configured and receives the context needed for the requested response.

Need help?

If onboarding reports an error that is not resolved by the steps above, capture the exact message shown in ThoughtWaveAI and contact ThoughtWaveAI support.